

BASIS (Hangzhou)

Instructor: Benjamin Jenkins

Email: Benjamin.jenkins-bihz@basischina.com

Student Hours: Thursday, 15:40, A224

Parent Hours: Wednesday 15:40 – 16:40

COURSE DESCRIPTION

5th Grade Science is designed to build upon students' prior knowledge and prepare them for middle school science. Students will deepen their understanding of each branch of science as they study the principles of chemistry, physics, biology, and space science. Students will practice scientific skills and principles with an emphasis on the scientific method, critical thinking, and collaborative problem solving. Students will also take responsibility for developing organizational, note-taking and studying skills, supported by teachers and parents.

GRADING POLICY

Assessments 60%

Classwork 30%

Homework 10%

GRADING SCALE

All grades will correspond to the following scale:

A = 90 – 100%

B = 80 – 89%

C = 70 – 79%

D = 60 – 69%

F = 0 – 59%

Classroom Rules and Expectations:

1. Be respectful
2. Be responsible
3. Be encouraging
4. Make wise choices
5. Follow directions quickly

There is an expectation that students will practice being independent and **proactive**. They will learn and use techniques to focus, listen to directions and ask questions to clarify. Students are expected to seek help when they are unsure of something.

Organization/Preparation: With appropriate support, students are expected to take responsibility for their needs in order to participate fully in class, which includes: being on time, getting focused, bringing necessary materials, asking questions, following directions, treating others with care and respect, promoting a positive learning environment, and being ready to interact with the fascinating world around us!

Communication Journal: Students must bring their Communication Journals each day and will be checked at the start of every class. The Communication Journal is the **primary method** of communication between teachers and parents. Students are expected to write down homework assignments, in-class lessons, announcements, and upcoming tests or quizzes.

Parents, please review and the Science section of your student's CJ to be informed of class assignments, projects, activities, and teacher notes.

Attendance: If a student is absent, it is the student's responsibility to follow up with the teacher about material that was missed during student hours or after class. Students should check in with their LET and come to student hours to catch up. Absences will be considered regarding late work, which need not be completed during the absence. It is the student's responsibility to remember to turn in missed assignments from their LET and make up missed quizzes and tests.

Academic Integrity: Plagiarism is the representation of another's words or ideas as one's own in any academic work. To avoid plagiarism, every direct quotation and paraphrase/summary must be identified with proper citations, which students will be taught.

Common forms of plagiarism may include:

- Copying from the internet
- Copying from another student
- Failing to give credit for an author's ideas that you have quoted, paraphrased or summarized in your own words
- Re-using your work for multiple classes or assignments
- Knowingly misrepresenting quoted evidence

Any suspicion of plagiarism may be immediately referred to the Dean of Students and treated as a discipline violation (See Parent-Student Handbook).

Classroom Discipline: Students are expected to follow school rules in the Parent-Student Handbook as well as classroom rules set at the beginning of the year. Violation of school and/or classroom rules will result in a consequence that can include a verbal warning, a write-up in the communication journal, communication to the parent/guardian, or a referral to the Dean of Students, according to school policy.

Lab Safety: Laboratory activities and projects will occur occasionally during the course. It is important for the safety of everyone to follow all instructions, written or verbal, when handling lab equipment and tools. Violations to rules may result in a failing grade for the activity and possible referral to the Dean of Students for discipline violation.

Cell phones or electronic devices policy: Cell phones are not allowed during school hours. Parents can reach students during an emergency through the school's office. Cell phones are not allowed for calculators. **Smart watches and similar devices must be kept secured in a bag or cubby during class** time unless special permission is granted.

INSTRUCTIONAL MATERIALS

- A textbook is not required for this course. Any textbook is a reference and is used to supplement to what is taught in class.
- Students' science journals will be the main source of learning this school year and should be brought to class every day.
- Teacher notes and handouts will be provided in class.
- Additional software and online resources and videos will be utilized throughout the year.
- Not all materials may be shared digitally.

CLASSROOM POLICIES

To succeed in science, take 15 minutes every day to:

- Review material, including class notes and homework.
- Use flashcards or other word recall methods to learn and expand vocabulary.
- Keep science folder tidy, updated, and containing only science materials.
- Write assignments in the Communication Journal and check it with parents.
- Write questions to ask your teacher during class or student hour.
- Strive for YOUR best work, making yourself proud without comparing to others.
- Most importantly; stay curious, critical, and open-minded!

Assessments:

Assessments include tests, quizzes, vocabulary quizzes or larger projects. Tests and quizzes will require students to apply concepts studied within class. Assessments will alternate between Quizzes and Tests. Tests will usually cover topics covered over two weeks. Tests are announced at least 5 days before the date. Students will be given a test study guide. Quizzes are meant to more frequently assess understanding of material between tests. There is no study guide for quizzes. Students will have an entire class period to complete the test. Quizzes will be of a shorter duration. Both tests and quizzes will be a mix of multiple choice and long answer questions.

For a student who scores lower than 70% on either a test or a quiz, there will be one opportunity offered to complete corrections on that assessment (under special circumstances, a teacher may allow a re-take). Corrections must be submitted on time and according to instructions. In general, corrections will be due 3 school days from the time the assessment scores are announced and **must contain a short explanation** explaining the reason behind each correct answer.

The correction score will be capped at 70%.

The correction grade will be the final grade for the assessment.

Projects related to students' learning in class will be periodically assigned. These will be a combination of individual and collaborative projects. A rubric that explains the grading criteria will be provided for each project.

Classwork: Course notes, warmups, do-nows, lab activities, and other subject-related activities may be kept in the Science Journal and Science Folder provided for science class. Student grades will be dependent on finishing assigned classwork, vocabulary activities, participating in assigned collaborative work, and preparedness and periodic notebook checks. **Students should come to class daily with their CJ, Science Journal and Science Folder.**

Homework: Homework will be assigned to reinforce concepts learned in class and prepare students for class discussions. At times, it may include finishing classwork or doing assigned activities. Assigned work is usually due the next day. Answers will be checked as a class on the day it is due. **Late work is marked off by 20% each day it is late.** If no homework is assigned, students are recommended to review vocabulary, notes and class materials for at least 15 minutes each day.